

JANUARY 1-15, 1979

This is not just confined to India, but is apparent in the US as well. Many famous American companies, banks and financial institutions have gone bankrupt and many are on the verge of it. I feel India is still in a better position to reverse this with better and stronger management.

A. SRIKANTIAH, *Bangalore*

It is time for creative and innovative plans to mobilise domestic capital to arrest the country's decline in growth rate. Indian business minds are quite capable of insulating the economy from the global free fall by their prudent and efficient entrepreneurship.

K.V. RAGHURAM, *Wayanad*

Panel Hassle

The case for the scrapping of these commissions is almost ironclad ("Commissions of Omission", November 24). There is little chance of this happening due to the mileage the commission reports generate for politicians and the interminable sinecures they provide. They also offer the chattering classes immense scope to use up air time to pass their judgments on the judges who are heading the commissions and their findings.

M.H. RAO, *Hyderabad*

The basic flaw lies in the judges' constitution. Superior court judges do not have the experience in

finding facts. Their expertise lies in evaluation of the facts presented by trial courts and interpretation of the laws. To put them on the job of fact-finding is to put a square peg in a round hole. Sessions judges are better equipped for this role. Instead of creating sinecures for conducting judicial inquiries, it will be time- and cost-effective to set up benches in session courts to hold quick inquiries.

BISHAN SAHAI,

via www.indiatoday.in

1917 and settled himself in our family residence, Sheeshmahal, as a *ghar jamaai*. Your story is incorrect and highly defamatory to my family and I. You have made it out to be a fight between two people trying to outdo one another through allegations and counter-allegations.

NAWAB IBRAHIM ALI KHAN SHISHMAHAL, President, Royal Family of Awadh and Nawabeen-e-Awadh Foundation, *Lucknow*

Nawab Ibrahim Ali Khan

NARENDRA BISHT



“ Margaret Alva has been part of the Congress for long and the accusation made by her probably weighs more than the denial of an election ticket for her son. ”

H.R. BAPU SATYANARAYANA, *Mysore*

Nawab Row

Jafar Mir Abdullah's family and mine are not "two parallel families" ("Fake Nawab", August 18). My family has roots in Awadh, while Jafar Mir Abdullah's has roots in Patna. His grandfather married my grandfather's cousin in

Shishmahal has not cited a single word or sentence that could be considered defamatory. We have given every opportunity to both sides to comment on every aspect of the dispute. We stand by the story.

EDITOR

City Homage

Calcutta will be the first city in the world to honour Sir Charlie Chaplin with a life-size statue, and Lady Oona Chaplin is being invited to unveil the bronze likeness of her husband. The Rs 1.5-lakh statue will be installed by the end of 1979 in the small municipal park opposite the musty Calcutta Corporation building. The area has already been renamed Charlie Chaplin Square. A more suitable site could not have been chosen. For, from his perch, the legendary tramp (as Chaplin will be portrayed, complete with Derby hat, out-size shoes, ill-fitting clothes and twirling cane) will watch over the vagrants who wash, bathe and sleep on the pavement outside the park. "The spot is not the most beautiful in Calcutta," wrote *The Statesman* in its Notebook. "But then Charlie, born in the East End of London, would have a sympathetic eye for squalor."

Jimi Hafizji



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